

files that have changed. Since only incremental changes are saved, minimal disk space is used for shadow copies. Note that shadow copies are deeply tied in with the System Restore feature of Vista. In order to save shadow copies of a file, you need to enable System Restore for the drive or partition that houses your files.

Shadow copies can be restored by right-clicking on a file/folder and choosing “Restore previous versions”.



It's like a single-file system restore!

10.2 System Restore

System Restore was introduced in Windows XP to enable people to restore their computers to an earlier state without losing personal data. System Restore is like an OS-level undo feature which allows you to roll back on system-wide changes—be it through software installs, driver updates or OS updates—without affecting your personal files, such as e mails, documents, or photos. Restore points can be created across hard drives through the System Protection feature. You don't have to worry about taking periodic system snapshots—System Restore automatically creates easily-identifiable restore points. You can also manually create restore points at any time.

To set up hard drives and partitions for System Restore, open the System window by typing in “Sys” in the Start Menu and clicking on “System”. Then click on the “System protection” option on the left pane of the System window. This will open up the “System Properties” window under the “System Protection” tab. You can enable disks and partitions to fall under the System Restore umbrella here—just select the checkboxes in front of the drives or partitions, and then click on “Create...”